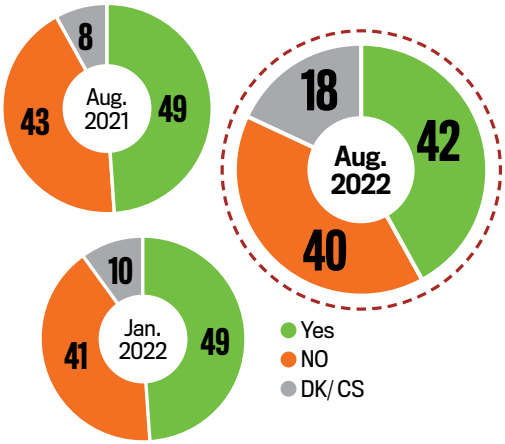
Q. Do you think an Opposition alliance to challenge the Modi-led BJP at the Centre is possible?



(All figures in percentage; DK/ CS: Don't know/ Can't say)



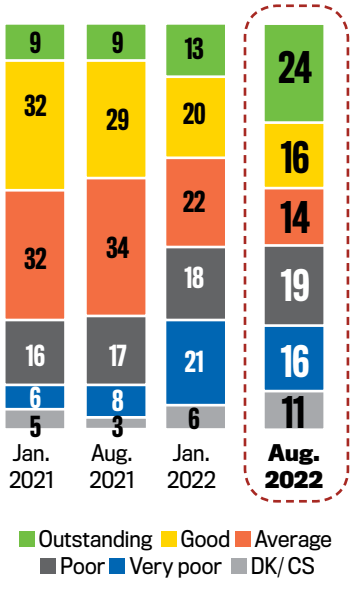
NO ECHOES Opposition leaders at a presser outside Parliament

ANI

Like most other nations, India too has been bearing the brunt of global political and economic developments—the Russia-Ukraine war and rising crude oil prices. The country's foreign reserves are depleting, and the rupee has hit record lows against the dollar. Under the circumstances, the ruling BJP should have been running for cover, desperately defending their performance as the country's top Opposition leaders squatted on the streets of Delhi and demanded answers.

Instead, by evening, the Congress leaders were busy justifying the agitation against price rise and unemployment. The ruling BJP alleged it was a party ploy to divert attention from the ongoing investigation by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) against Congress president Sonia Gandhi and her Lok Sabha MP son Rahul Gandhi on charges of money laundering for transactions involving the Congress party, the Associated Journals Ltd, a public company set up by India's first prime minister, the late Jawaharlal Nehru, and Young Indian, a private unlisted company where the mother-son duo are directors.

Q. How would you rate the performance of the Congress as an Opposition party?



(All figures in percentage)

Just a few weeks ago, when Sonia and Rahul were questioned by the ED, the Congress leaders had staged a countrywide protest. But then critics pointed out that party leaders, who had failed to lead a sustained agitation on any public issue since the Modi reign started, had come out of their cubbyholes only when the Gandhis were facing an ED grilling. The grand old party was hoping the August 5 protest would sweep away that criticism. The BJP, instead, packaged it as a new twist as the protest happened two days after the ED had sealed the office of Young Indian. What's more, Union home minister Amit Shah found another sinister design in its timing—dismissing it as another subtle bid to promote minority appeasement by the Congress as exactly a year ago Modi had laid the foundation of the Ram temple in Ayodhya.

It's this issue of wrong timing